

Jedi on Tauntauns

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Introduction

This is a rules-lite hack of [Kids on Bikes](#) for use in a Star Wars setting. The intention of this system is to create a simple framework for telling shared, improvised stories with your friends. It is not intended as a simulationist engine for highly tactical gameplay. The emphasis should always be on having fun, moving the story forward, and player agency in service of the story.

Dice Mechanics

Jedi on Tauntauns uses all the standard polyhedral dice, except the d100. In all situations where you roll dice, rolling the maximum value of the die allows you to roll the die again, adding the second result cumulatively (i.e. dice explode). Dice may explode infinitely. The result of the roll is compared to either a target number or the result of a competitor's roll.

In general, the margin of success on a check should determine the scale of the outcome. If you succeed by a wide margin, you will have much more success than if you only just barely succeeded on the check. Similarly, just barely failing a check is not as bad as failing by a wide margin. The impact of a success or failure on a check should also take into account the scale of the action. Failing to chat up the barman will have much less impact than failing to convince the guards that you do actually belong in this high-security facility, even for the same degree of failure.

Standard Checks

A standard check is any check not covered by a more specific set of rules. When you make a standard check, the GM sets a target number for the check. You then roll your die for the Stat called for by the GM. If the result of your roll meets or exceeds the target number, you succeed on the check. Otherwise, you fail the check.

Contested Checks

A contested check is called for when two or more characters in a scene are competing over the outcome of an action. To resolve a contested check, each character makes a roll with the Stat they are using for the check (as determined by the GM). The highest result is the victor. Tied results represent a stalemate, and do not count as failures.

Twist of Destiny

Anytime a character rolls a 1 on a die, they automatically fail the check as the will of the Force turns against them and some outside influence causes their attempt to go awry. This outside force could be anything from a stormtrooper showing up at an inopportune moment to deflector shields coming back online just before their attacks land, or anything else. The intention is that this is an outside force preventing their success, not a failure on their part to succeed.

Destiny Points

Whenever a character fails a check of any kind they receive a Destiny Point. By default Destiny Points can be spent in the following ways:

- Add a +1 bonus to any roll of yours

- Add a +1 bonus to a Planned Action of another character

Any number of Destiny Points can be spent on a single roll. The bonus for Destiny Points is applied as specified in the Bonuses and Penalties section below. Feats may add additional uses for Destiny Points.

A character may have no more than 5 Destiny Points at any time. If Destiny Points would be gained past 5, they are instead lost immediately.

Destiny Points do not carry over between sessions.

Planned Actions

If a character is under no time pressure or stress when they make a check, they may make that check as a Planned Action. When making a Planned Action an actor may:

- Take half of the maximum die value for the Stat being used, instead of rolling the die (i.e. d10 -> 5, d12 -> 6, etc.)
- Receive help from other players, who spend can their Destiny Points to grant a +1 bonus to the roll

Bonuses and Penalties

Spending Destiny Points and some Feats will provide bonuses or penalties to your checks. Both bonuses and penalties are applied after the roll is complete and before you evaluate success or failure. This means that they cannot make a die explode or prevent a die from exploding.

Characters

Characters in *Jedi on Tauntauns* are very simple mechanically. The intention is to keep the mechanics of the characters simple so that players can focus on the roleplaying and storytelling without getting bogged down in dice rolls. As the Stats discussed below are broadly defined, it is up to the player to decide in what ways it is reasonable for their character to employ those statistics.

Mechanically, each player is composed of seven Stats and any number of Feats. Each Stat (except maybe Force Sensitivity) will have a dice type assigned to it as part of character creation. Additionally, Feats are available any time changes are made to a character.

Stats

There are seven stats, listed with explanations below, that govern all of the checks that you might make as a character in *Jedi on Tauntauns*. Each stat is defined by its die size (i.e. d4, d6, d8, d10, d12, d20), though the Force Sensitivity Stat is potentially 0. All other stats start at d4 and are improved by moving up die sizes during character creation and any Improvement Phases. Stats are listed below with descriptions of the types of activities they cover.

Force Sensitivity

This Stat is unique in that it defaults to 0, meaning that it cannot be used in a check. Once this Stat has a die size assigned, you will use this Stat for any checks that involve the use of the Force, whether that's in manipulating objects, persuading people, or sensing presences.

Athleticism

The Athleticism Stat determines the physical conditioning (i.e. how strong and fast) of a character. This Stat covers any check that involves physical activity and does not involve combat. This is everything from running fast to sneaking around on foot to lifting heavy objects to playing sports and beyond.

Brains

The Brains Stat determines the book-smarts of a character. This Stat covers any check to recall knowledge, solve intellectual problems, understand languages, or perform medicine.

Charm

The Charm Stat determines how socially adept a character is. This Stat covers any check to read other characters, lie, cheat, persuade, or interact with sentient and non-sentient creatures.

Technician

The Technician Stat determines how well your character is able to work with technology and handle vehicles, regardless of scale or type. This Stat covers any check to manipulate/modify/repair technology, pilot a vehicle, or modify/repair vehicles.

Fight

The Fight Stat determines how competent a character is in combat scenarios. This Stat covers any check related to aggressive action in combat. This Stat may also be used in place of Charm in some social situations when intimidation is used.

Grit

The Grit Stat determines how durable your character is. This Stat covers any check to resist an aggressive action in combat, as well as to resist environmental or psychological hazards. Grit may also be used for checks that rely on how street-smart a character is, whether that is navigating a slum or surviving in a sandstorm.

Perception-style Checks

You may notice that there is no skill that covers the types of actions typically covered by perception or insight-style checks in other systems. Instead of having a dedicated skill for those actions, players can expect to make checks using the skills relevant to the situation or type of information they are seeking. Some examples include:

Kalon wants to see if the door he is about to enter is trapped. The GM will ask Kalon for a Technician roll, because any trap would rely on technology.

Sira wants to track her quarry across a marsh. The GM will ask Sira for a Grit roll, because tracking another character is a street-smarts skill.

Threx wants to know if the smuggler is lying to them. The GM will ask Threx for an opposed Charm check against the smuggler, as this is a social situation.

The intention with having perception and insight-style checks handled in this manner is that it allows players to lean into their strengths while keeping the mechanics simple.

Feats

Feats are additional abilities you can unlock that provide bonuses, create new actions, or otherwise manipulate the rules for your character. The intention of Feats is to help you make your character your own by capturing aspects of the character that aren't covered by the Stats of the character. Generally, it is encouraged that you create your own feats that are personalized to your character. You should work with your GM to ensure the Feats you create are fun and appropriately costed.

Fun Feats generally do more than add bonuses to your die rolls (though that is fine too!). They might help you pull in new NPC contacts, highlight your skills in specific social situations, or give you combat abilities that are a little out there. Introducing new constraints on your character along with the upsides of a Feat can also be a fun roleplaying exercise and give your character some more life.

To help you get started with creating your own Feats, some example Feats are listed below.

Feat	Cost	Description
Favored Weapon	2 IP	Pick a type of weapon. When you make a Fight check with that type of weapon, you get a +2 bonus to that check. When you make a Fight check with a different type of weapon, you take a -1 penalty to that check.
Big Backpack	2 IP	You have a big backpack filled with useful objects. You may spend 1 Destiny Point to retrieve common object that could have fit in the backpack without having previously stated you acquired it. Because your backpack is so filled with random items, you take a -1 penalty to any Athleticism checks you make.
Snitch	1 IP	Spend a Destiny Point to locate and receive help (within reason) from law enforcement in any settlement with a problem involving a crime.
Underworld Connections	1 IP	Spend a Destiny Point to get an introduction to an underworld figure.
My Hunk of Junk	1 IP	Pick a specific vehicle. When you make a Technician check for that vehicle, you get a +2 bonus to that check. When you no longer possess that vehicle, you fall into a deep funk.
Excellent Assistant	1 IP	When you spend Destiny Points on an ally's Planned Action, each Destiny Point you spend provides a +2 bonus.
Fated	3 IP	When you fail a check you receive two Destiny Points instead of one.
Nerves of Steel	1 IP	When you make a check that is not a Planned Action, you may spend 1 Destiny Point to take half of your die's value instead of rolling.
Infamous	1 IP	When you make a Charm check against underworld targets, you get a +2 bonus to that check. When you make a Charm check against a figure of authority, you take a -2 penalty to that check.
Guardian	2 IP	When a nearby ally would take an Injury Level, you may spend two Destiny Points to receive that Injury level instead.
Tough	2 IP	You have two Minor Injury Levels before your Major Injury Level.
Will of the Force	3 IP	Once per session you may choose to spend your Destiny Points during your roll, instead of after the roll. This means that you may spend

Feat	Cost	Description
		Destiny Points to cause a die to explode.
Fast Disguise	1 IP	If you are unobserved, you may spend 1 Destiny Point to completely change your appearance
Legal Action	2 IP	When you attack an enemy, you may instead quote from relevant local legislation and ordinances. Make a Brains check contested by Grit. If you succeed, your enemy is put into a stupor.
Junkyard Special	1IP	Your cybernetic leg is a patchwork of old parts and questionable repairs. Once per scene, flip a coin. If it comes up heads, gain a +2 bonus to your next Athleticism or Fight check that involves your leg. If it comes up tails, take a -2 penalty on your next Athleticism or Fight check that involves your leg.

Injury Levels

All player characters have five Injury Levels by default. These levels are as follows:

1. Uninjured
2. Minor Injury
3. Major Injury
4. Unconscious
5. Dead

When a character has a Major Injury, they receive a -2 penalty to all checks. An Unconscious character automatically fails all checks except Grit checks, to which they receive a -4 penalty.

Harm

Generally, aggressive actions are resolved with a Contested Check with the aggressor rolling Fight and the Defender rolling Grit. If the aggressor succeeds, the defender moves to the next Injury Level (i.e. Uninjured -> Minor Injury -> Major Injury etc.).

Healing

When a character has an Injury Level, they can generally reduce their Injury Level by benefitting from a successful Brains check. Additionally, they can recover once a sufficient amount of time has passed.

Character Creation

As with all RPGs, it is important to have a concept for your character. In *Jedi on Tauntauns* it is possibly even more important to have a strong idea of the character that you would like to play, since you are responsible for coming up with many of the mechanics of the character.

When creating a new character, you will build your character out of a pool of 14 Improvement Points (IP). The mechanical character should be created following these steps:

1. Pick a species for your character. Work with your GM to decide a Stat that should be increased by one die size and to create a Feat specific to your species that you gain for free.
2. Distribute your 14 IP by spending them in any of the following ways:
 1. Spend 1 IP to increase a Stat by 1 die size, up to d12

2. Spend 2 IP to increase a Stat from d12 to d20
3. Spend IP equal to its cost to gain a Feat of your choice

When creating a character you are encouraged to spend your IP on both Stats and Feats. Having lots of Stats and few feats may lead to your character being boring. Having lots of Feats and not very many Stats could be an interesting character, but would likely feel bad to play, as your character would be bad at everything they tried.

Improvement Phases

Whenever you enter an Improvement Phase, you are granted 2 additional IP. You may then spend any IP you have (including leftover IP from character creation or previous Improvement phases), as defined in the Character Creation section above.

Gear

Gear is exclusively narrative. This means that while you may need a specific piece of gear to be allowed to perform some actions, gear does not provide any Stat or other bonuses beyond that.

Please note that these rules intentionally do not provide a system for tracking currency. It is up to you and your GM to decide what role, if any, currency plays in your story.

Vehicles

Vehicles are similar, but not the same as characters. Every vehicle will have a set of five Specs. Each of these Specs covers a range of activities you might perform while using the vehicle. Each Spec is a bonus or penalty that is applied to your character's roll whenever you make a Stat check to perform a related activity. Additionally, each vehicle can have a number of Modules that expand its capabilities.

Specs

Specs define the performance characteristics of a vehicle. All Specs start at a value of 0 and cannot be improved past 3.

Speed

Speed covers activities related to the speed of the vehicle, typically outrunning other vehicles or traveling between places. Checks related to the Speed Spec are typically performed with a Technician Stat check.

Maneuverability

Maneuverability covers activities related to maneuvering the vehicle, like navigating through tricky spots or losing pursuing craft. Checks related to the Maneuverability Spec are typically performed with a Technician Stat check.

Firepower

Firepower covers aggressive activities performed with your vehicle. This includes everything from firing your quadlasers to ramming an opposing vehicle. Checks related to the Firepower Spec are typically performed with a Fight Stat check.

Durability

Durability covers how well your vehicle stands up to the wear and tear of use. This means everything from taking a turbolaser impact to getting in a fender bender. Checks related to the Durability Spec are typically performed with a Technician check.

Systems

Systems covers activities that are related to the use of specific Modules in place on your vehicle that are not covered by another Spec. This means everything from the sensors to the medical bay to the cloaking device to the astronav. Checks related to the Systems Spec are typically performed with a Brains check.

Modules

Every vehicle can have some number of Modules that provide additional capabilities. Examples of these are listed below, but you should always feel free to work with your GM to design additional new Modules. Some Modules may directly increase or decrease the bonuses and penalties your vehicle's Specs provide, while other Modules may simply provide new capabilities. You can think of Modules like Feats.

Module	Cost	Description
Improved Maneuvering Jets	1VP	Increase this vehicle's Maneuverability Spec by 1.
Greater Improved Maneuvering Jets	2VP	Increase this vehicle's Maneuverability Spec by 1.
Concealed Compartments	1VP	This vehicle now has hidden cargo containers
Distinctive Livery	1VP	This vehicle is painted in a distinctive livery. If this livery is associated with a particular organization, you receive a +2 bonus to Charm checks related to that organization while in or near the vehicle. This vehicle receives a -2 penalty to checks while trying to pretend to be a different vehicle.
A Hydrospanner a Day...	1VP	One or more characters may spend a full day wrenching on this vehicle. For one week or until this vehicle is next damaged (whichever comes first), this vehicle receives a +1 bonus to all Specs.

If you are creating Modules that increase the Specs of the vehicle, each Module should cost 1 more VP than the previous Module (i.e. the first costs 1VP, the second costs 2VP, and the third costs 3VP).

Vehicles and Damage

Unlike characters, vehicles track damage using their Modules. Whenever a vehicle takes damage, one of its Modules is destroyed. When a vehicle has no remaining Modules, it is destroyed. This does not necessarily mean that it explodes or ceases to exist - it may simply be disabled or drifting in space without any power.

As Modules are destroyed, they no longer provide their effects.

Repairing Vehicles

It is possible to repair destroyed Module given enough time. To fully repair a destroyed Module, characters may make a Technician check and spend the appropriate amount of time (typically a more than a day) performing the repairs. Alternately, players may spend 1 Vehicle Point to have someone else repair the destroyed Module.

Vehicle Creation

Creating vehicles is very similar to creating characters. Vehicles are created out of a pool of 8 Vehicle Points (VP). To create the mechanical profile of the vehicle, follow the following steps:

1. Pick a vehicle. Work with your GM to determine one Spec to increase to +1 and one Module to add to the vehicle.
2. Distribute your 8 VP by spending them on Modules.

Vehicle Improvement

Whenever you get a Vehicle Improvement (as decided with your GM) you are granted 2 additional VP. You may then spend any VP you have (including leftover VP from vehicle creation or previous Vehicle Improvements) on repairing destroyed Modules or acquiring new Modules.

Examples

Example Character Build

Alex decides they wants to play a Wookie enforcer for a small-time crime boss named Nyysh. Since they have decided on playing a Wookie, they starts by working with their GM to determine which Stat should start at d6. Together, they decide that Athleticism will start at d6 to reflect the natural strength of Wookies.

Next, Alex and their GM come up with a starting Feat for Wookies. They decide to make a new Feat:

Feat	Cost	Description
Fearsome Strength	N/A	When you make an Athleticism check based on strength, each Destiny Point you spend increases your result by 2 instead of 1.

Now that Alex and their GM have decided on the Stat boost and Feat from being a Wookie, it is up to Alex to decide how to spend their 14 IP to complete building Nyysh.

Since Alex wants Nyysh to be a very competent fighter they spend 6 of those points to increase Nyysh's Fight Stat to a d20. This requires them to spend 4 points to reach d12 (d4 -> d6, d6 -> d8, d8 -> d10, and d10 ->d12) and 2 points to reach d20 (d12 -> d20).

Then, Alex spends 2 points on Nyysh's Grit to bring it up to d8, 1 point on Athleticism to bring it up to d8. Alex puts 1 point into Charm to bring it up do d6. Then Alex puts 2 points into Technician, since they wants to represent Nyysh's driving skills, which brings Nyysh's Technician Stat up to d8.

With their last 2 points, Alex decides to take two Feats. The first, Underworld Connections, is described above, and represents the connections Nyysh has formed while working in the underworld. The second

Feat is another that Alex makes up and gets approved by their GM, Aggressive Demeanor.

Feat	Cost	Description
Aggressive Demeanor	1 IP	When you use Athleticism to try to intimidate a target, you receive a +2 bonus to that check. If you fail that check, the target is much more likely to react with violence.

This completes the mechanical character creation process for Alex's character. In the end, Nyysh will have the following profile:

Force Sensitivity	Athleticism	Brains	Charm	Fight	Grit	Technician
0	d8	d4	d6	d20	d8	d8

Feat	Cost	Description
Fearsome Strength	N/A	When you make an Athleticism check based on strength, each Destiny Point you spend increases your result by 2 instead of 1.
Aggressive Demeanor	1 IP	When you use Athleticism to try to intimidate a target, you receive a +2 bonus to that check. If you fail that check, the target is much more likely to react with violence.
Underworld Connections	1 IP	Spend a Destiny Point to get an introduction to an underworld figure.

Example Vehicle Build

Now that Alex has created Nyysh it is time to create Nyysh's vehicle.